

Bulgaria

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	6.44 m
GDP	EUR 116 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	220 k
Electricity price	141.3 EUR/MWh
Renewables	33.8%
Live hyperscaler regions	0

2 What is structurally different

- Frontline exposure. A land border with Russia or Belarus (or a Black Sea coast facing the war) changes the threat model from *geopolitical supply disruption* to *kinetic and sabotage risk against the facilities themselves*. Defense and security workloads are scaled up 1.5x/1.25x in the baseline, and at least one site should be hardened (EMP/blast, autonomous power for weeks, not hours). A purely national footprint cannot provide the out-of-country cold copy that Estonia's Data Embassy already demonstrates; this is the first item to revisit when the EU federation layer (Dutch GOAL.md section 16) is modelled.
- High seismic risk. Base isolation or seismic-rated structures are mandatory, not optional, at the primary site; the second and third regions should be chosen in a different seismic domain so a single event cannot take out two regions. Expect facility CAPEX above the EUR 10 m/MW planning figure.
- No hyperscaler region in-country. Unlike the Netherlands, there is no commercial hyperscale tier to fall back on for non-critical workloads without leaving the jurisdiction. The sovereign core therefore has to be sized for a larger share of total government demand, and the hybrid model (Dutch GOAL.md section 7) needs a cross-border commercial tier.

3 Capacity

Servers	1,749 (CPU 1,239 / GPU 71 / storage 439)
IT critical load	2.8 MW
Facility design load	4.2 MW
Sites	3 (by capacity 1, floor 3)
Average per site	1.4 MW
Site count set by	the minimum-sites floor, not capacity
CAPEX	EUR 98 m
OPEX	EUR 9 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Sofia	Primary civil cloud	41%	1.7	SHPC estate, BIX/NetIX, EuroHPC Discoverer; seismic design required.
Plovdiv	Sovereign secondary	27%	1.1	Second metro, 150 km separation, Maritsa industrial grid.
North-central / Veliko Tarnovo - Pleven	Government / continuity	23%	0.9	Inland, away from the Black Sea frontier and Vrancea influence.
Varna	Strategic reserve	10%	0.4	Cable landings, but Black Sea exposure - reserve/edge only.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	e-Government Act; State e-Government Agency (SEGA) mandates use of the state hybrid cloud
Cloud certification	No national scheme; ISO 27001
Data classification	Protection of Classified Information Act: For Official Use / Confidential / Secret / Top Secret
Procurement route	Ministry of e-Government central purchasing; CPV framework

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. Limited; Microsoft 365 in parts of central administration, no in-country region

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	State Hybrid Private Cloud (SHPC) for e-Governance - Ministry of e-Government / Information Services JSC (upgraded 2024)
Maturity	operational
Digital identity	Bulgarian eID (biometric ID card + Evrotrust); EUDI wallet law in draft
Interconnection	BIX.BG and NetIX Sofia; Varna Black Sea landings

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	1.1	EUR 21 m	22%	no
2	Security and defense	2.1	EUR 50 m	73%	no
3	State record	0.6	EUR 15 m	88%	no
4	Elective	0.5	EUR 12 m	100%	no

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 21 m** for 1.1 MW, 22% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

Moderate-high seismic (Vrancea influence; Sofia/Plovdiv zones); Danube floods; cheap abundant land; Black Sea frontline (drone/mine incidents at Varna/Burgas); gas diversified from Russia post-2022; nuclear baseload but ageing grid